

Five minutes to a deadline-proof pipeline.

One workbook, seven connected sheets. Start in the tool you already use — everything below takes less time than making coffee.

Microsoft Excel (recommended)

1. Unzip nothing — just double-click `Grant-Publication-Tracker.xlsx`.
2. If Excel shows a yellow "Protected View" bar, click **Enable Editing** (the file comes from a download, that's all).
3. Read the **Start Here** tab (60 seconds), then add your first application in **Grants**.

Google Sheets

1. Go to `sheets.google.com` and open a blank spreadsheet.
2. Menu **File** → **Import** → **Upload**, choose `Grant-Publication-Tracker.xlsx`.
3. Pick **"Replace spreadsheet"** and confirm. Formulas, dropdowns and colors survive the trip.
4. Rename the file (e.g. "Grant & Publication Tracker") — done.

LibreOffice & Apple Numbers

LibreOffice Calc opens the file out of the box. Apple Numbers works too — minor visual differences possible. For the smoothest experience we recommend Excel or Google Sheets.

Three habits that make it work

① Every call you consider goes into **Grants** as a row the moment you find it — even the uncertain ones. ② When you submit: switch the status, enter the date — the countdown goes quiet by itself. ③ Five minutes on the **Dashboard** every Monday: anything under 21 days is this week's job.

Good to know

- The **Dashboard** computes itself — never type there (it's protected against accidents; you can unprotect it anytime). Grey cells anywhere mean the same: they compute themselves.
- **Days in review** (Publications) turns amber at 90 days while the decision is pending — that's when a polite nudge to the editor is fair game.
- The **AI Prompts** sheet: copy a prompt, fill the [brackets], paste into ChatGPT, Claude or any assistant. The thinking stays yours.
- **Questions or a broken formula?** Message us on Etsy — we reply within 48 h.